BMW Z4

COMPLETE CAR GUIDE

India-focused overview • Engineering • Features • Ownership

A practical reference for buyers, enthusiasts and students

Prepared October 2026. This guide summarizes public manufacturer information and general automotive knowledge. It is not a substitute for the exact specification sheet, owner's manual, insurance quote or written dealer offer for a specific vehicle.

How to use this guide

The BMW Z4 is a two-seat, front-engine, rear-wheel-drive roadster designed around open-top driving and sporty handling. Equipment and performance depend on the model, market and production year. This guide focuses on the third-generation G29 and Indian-market information published by BMW India, particularly the Z4 sDrive20i and Z4 M40i variants documented in official specifications.

Important date note: BMW's India specification sheets cited here are from earlier model-year releases. They are useful for understanding the car and its published configurations, but they do not guarantee that a particular variant, colour, feature, price or offer is available in October 2026. Confirm current details with BMW India or an authorised dealer.

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1. BMW Z4 at a glance

The BMW Z4 is a premium two-seat roadster with a retractable fabric soft top. The current-generation design combines a long bonnet, low seating position, rear-wheel drive and a driver-focused cockpit. It is intended to deliver a more involving open-air driving experience than a conventional coupe or sedan.

Item	Overview
Vehicle type	Two-seat premium sports roadster / convertible
Generation covered	Third generation, commonly identified by BMW's G29 chassis code
Layout	Front engine, rear-wheel drive
Roof	Power-operated fabric soft top
Fuel	Petrol; exact fuel requirements depend on the engine and market
Transmission	8-speed Steptronic Sport automatic in the Indian variants discussed here
India variants in published sheets	Z4 sDrive20i and Z4 M40i
Best-known strengths	Open-top experience, strong turbocharged engines, rear-wheel-drive dynamics and premium cabin
Main compromise	Only two seats and limited luggage space compared with a practical daily car

The Z4 is not the same as a BMW M car such as an M2 or M4. The M40i is a performance-oriented Z4 variant with M-specific chassis and styling equipment, but it is distinct from a full BMW M model.

2. Generations and design

The Z4 name has been used across multiple generations. Earlier versions used different body designs and roof mechanisms; the third-generation G29 is the modern roadster covered in this guide. When shopping used, always identify the model year, engine badge, chassis generation and local-market specification rather than relying on the Z4 name alone.

Design highlights

- Long bonnet and short rear deck create a classic roadster proportion.
- BMW kidney grille, sculpted front air intakes and pronounced body creases define the front and side profile.
- Low seating and a wide centre console create a cockpit that feels focused on the driver.
- The soft top gives the car a traditional convertible silhouette and can be raised for weather protection.
- The M40i typically adds more assertive M styling and performance-oriented equipment; exact details vary by year and market.

3. Engine, transmission and performance

BMW has offered the G29 Z4 with different turbocharged petrol engines depending on market and model year. The two variants commonly documented in BMW India's published sheets are the sDrive20i four-cylinder and M40i six-cylinder.

Specification	Z4 sDrive20i	Z4 M40i
Engine layout	2.0-litre turbocharged inline-four petrol	3.0-litre turbocharged inline-six petrol
Displacement	1,998 cc	2,998 cc
Published maximum output (India sheet)	145 kW / 197 hp	250 kW / 340 hp
Published maximum torque	320 Nm	500 Nm
0–100 km/h	6.6 seconds	4.5 seconds
Transmission	8-speed Steptronic Sport automatic	8-speed Steptronic Sport automatic
Drive	Rear-wheel drive	Rear-wheel drive
Character	Balanced roadster performance	More powerful, faster and more performance-focused

Figures above come from BMW India launch/specification material for the relevant published configurations. They are not a promise of the output or equipment of every Z4 sold in every year. Power may be expressed in metric horsepower (PS) or horsepower (hp) in different documents; use the exact unit stated by the source.

How the engine differences feel

- The sDrive20i's four-cylinder engine is the more modest option, with enough power for brisk road driving and a lower performance ceiling than the M40i.
- The M40i's inline-six is known for smoothness, stronger acceleration and a fuller performance character.
- Turbocharging helps both engines deliver useful torque without needing very high engine speeds all the time.
- The automatic transmission can shift smoothly in relaxed driving and respond more assertively in sportier modes.
- Rear-wheel drive contributes to the Z4's traditional sports-car balance; tyre condition and driver inputs matter greatly to grip.

Driving modes and chassis

Published Indian M40i specifications list features such as variable sport steering, an M Sport differential, adaptive M suspension and M Sport brakes. Driving Experience Control modes can alter the car's response, with mode names and available settings varying by model and year. These systems are designed to change the balance between comfort, responsiveness and dynamic control; they do not override the laws of physics or make unsafe driving safe.

Performance figures depend on test conditions, tyre setup, fuel, weather, vehicle load and the exact model year. Acceleration figures are manufacturer-published figures, not guaranteed real-world results.

4. Exterior, roof and lighting

The Z4's exterior is designed to look purposeful with the roof either raised or lowered. The fabric soft top is a major part of the car's identity and makes the car more compact and visually distinct from hardtop convertibles.

Roof use and care

- Follow the owner's manual for roof operation, vehicle-speed limits and required clearance.
- Keep the roof mechanism and drainage areas clean; debris can contribute to water-management problems.
- Do not operate the roof if the manual's conditions are not met, or if ice, obstructions or a fault warning is present.
- When buying used, inspect fabric condition, seams, seals, wind noise, roof movement and signs of water ingress.
- Ask the seller to demonstrate the complete roof cycle and check that the roof closes evenly.

Exterior equipment

Published specifications for the Indian M40i include LED lighting, a wind deflector, M Aerodynamics Package and BMW Individual Shadow Line elements. Some features, wheel designs, roof finishes and lighting upgrades may be optional or restricted to particular configurations. Always verify the build sheet for the actual car.

Wheels and tyres

BMW's published M40i sheet lists 19-inch M light-alloy wheel configurations and mixed-width tyres for certain versions. Tyre sizes, wheel designs and approved fitments can vary. Use the tyre placard and owner's manual for the specific vehicle, and avoid choosing replacement tyres based only on appearance.

5. Cabin, comfort and practicality

The Z4 has two seats, a low driving position and a cabin arranged around the driver. The M40i specification has included M Sport seats, a multifunction M leather steering wheel, electrically adjustable front seats with driver memory, ambient lighting and two-zone automatic climate control.

Comfort and everyday practicality

- Two-seat layout: there is no rear passenger bench, so it is not a family car for carrying more than one passenger.
- Boot space is limited relative to a sedan or SUV. Check the exact luggage capacity and shape for the model year, especially if you travel with large bags.
- Low ground clearance and a low seating position require care around steep ramps, potholes and tall speed breakers.
- The soft top makes open-air driving possible but adds roof-specific care and security considerations.
- Seat and steering adjustment are important: take a test drive to check visibility, comfort and ease of entry/exit.

Interior materials and trim

Depending on configuration, the cabin may feature Vernasca leather upholstery, Sensatec trim, contrasting stitching, aluminium-effect interior trim or high-gloss finishes. Upholstery colours and trim options are market- and year-dependent. Inspect leather wear, seat bolsters, switches, infotainment controls and the condition of any soft-touch surfaces in a used example.

6. Infotainment and connectivity

BMW's published Indian specification for the G29 Z4 M40i includes BMW Live Cockpit Professional with a 10.25-inch touchscreen, digital instrument display, navigation with 3D maps, iDrive control and wireless Apple CarPlay. Bluetooth audio and hands-free connectivity, USB connections and a HiFi loudspeaker system are also listed in relevant specification material.

Features documented for certain configurations

- Digital instrument cluster and central infotainment screen.
- Integrated navigation and 3D map presentation in the documented configuration.
- Wireless Apple CarPlay; smartphone integration availability should be checked for the exact vehicle.
- Bluetooth audio streaming, hands-free calls and USB connectivity.
- Standard HiFi audio system, with a Harman Kardon surround-sound system listed as optional in some specifications.
- Wireless charging and head-up display are listed as equipment that may vary by configuration.

Before purchase, test phone pairing, navigation, speakers, USB ports, reverse-camera display if fitted, software updates and all screen controls. Connectivity features can differ by phone, software version, market and subscription status.

7. Safety and driver assistance

BMW's published specification material lists a range of occupant-protection and vehicle-control systems. Equipment varies by year and market, so the following should be treated as a feature overview, not a guarantee that every system is installed on every Z4.

System	Purpose
Airbags	Help protect occupants in certain collision types; exact count and coverage depend on configuration.
ABS and Brake Assist	Help prevent wheel lock under hard braking and support emergency braking.
Dynamic Stability Control (DSC)	Helps manage loss of stability by selectively intervening within system limits.
Dynamic Traction Control (DTC)	Allows a different traction-control strategy in appropriate conditions.
Cornering Brake Control (CBC)	Helps manage braking stability during cornering.
Tyre-pressure / run-flat monitoring	Alerts the driver to certain tyre-pressure or tyre-related conditions; exact system varies.
Parking Distance Control	Uses sensors to warn of nearby obstacles where fitted.
Rear-view camera / Parking Assistant	May assist with low-speed parking on equipped vehicles.
Driving Assistant / active cruise functions	Availability and functions depend on the installed package and model year.

Safety reminders

- Confirm the airbag, seat-belt, stability-control and driver-assistance equipment on the specific car.
- Driver aids are assistance systems, not autonomous driving; the driver remains responsible.
- Check tyre condition, brake wear, service history and any warning lights before purchase.

- For a used vehicle, review accident repairs and have the chassis, airbag system and convertible roof inspected by a qualified workshop.

8. Ride, handling and everyday use

The Z4's appeal comes from its combination of open-top motoring, rear-wheel drive and a low, sporty driving position. The M40i adds more power and performance-oriented chassis hardware in the published configuration. The exact ride comfort depends on wheel and tyre setup, suspension equipment, road quality and driving mode.

Where the Z4 works well

- Weekend drives on suitable roads where the driver can enjoy the steering, engine and open roof.
- A personal luxury sports car for one driver and one passenger.
- Occasional city use when parking, road clearance and traffic conditions are manageable.
- Longer highway trips for two people, provided the luggage fits and the route is suitable.

Where it is less convenient

- Regularly carrying family, friends or more than one passenger.
- Frequent driving on broken roads, steep ramps or roads with large speed breakers.
- Carrying bulky luggage or shopping.
- Owners seeking low running costs, low insurance premiums or maximum fuel efficiency.
- Parking in exposed areas without considering soft-top security and weather protection.

India-specific considerations

In India, road surface quality, speed breakers, monsoon rain, dust, congestion and limited parking can affect the ownership experience. A pre-purchase drive should include the kind of roads you actually use. Check the underside and front bumper carefully, verify tyre availability and cost, and confirm that a nearby authorised BMW workshop can service the car.

9. Fuel economy and running costs

Fuel economy is affected by traffic, speed, temperature, driving style, tyre pressure, maintenance and fuel quality. BMW India specification documents have published different economy figures for different Z4 model years. Treat any brochure figure as a standardized test figure, not a promise of everyday mileage.

Major ownership-cost categories

Cost category	What to check
Fuel	Use the exact fuel grade recommended in the owner's manual; compare your likely city/highway use.
Insurance	Obtain quotes using the exact model year, variant, registration location and declared value.
Scheduled service	Ask for the current service schedule and a written quote from an authorised workshop.
Tyres and wheels	Performance tyres and larger wheels can be expensive; confirm sizes, availability and replacement costs.
Brakes	Pads, discs and labour costs can be significant on performance variants; inspect remaining life.
Convertible roof	Inspect seals, drains, fabric and mechanism; roof repairs can be costly.
Unexpected repairs	Check warranty status, service history, diagnostic codes and availability of parts.
Depreciation	Resale depends on condition, year, kilometres, service history, market demand and variant.

A simple way to estimate fuel spend: monthly fuel cost = monthly kilometres ÷ your observed km/L × local petrol price per litre. Use your own driving pattern rather than assuming the brochure's test figure.

Warranty and service packages

BMW India's published warranty policy describes a 24-month contractual warranty for combustion-engine models, with conditions and coverage terms. The warranty attached to a specific Z4 may differ by purchase date, market, extended-warranty purchase and vehicle history. Confirm coverage in writing and do not assume a used vehicle remains covered simply because it is a BMW.

10. Variant comparison

The table below compares the sDrive20i and M40i configurations described in BMW India's published material. It is intended to explain the differences, not to confirm present-day inventory or current prices.

Consideration	sDrive20i	M40i
Engine	2.0L turbo inline-four	3.0L turbo inline-six
Published output	197 hp	340 hp
Published torque	320 Nm	500 Nm
0–100 km/h	6.6 s	4.5 s
Driving character	Sporty, comparatively restrained	More powerful and performance-focused
Chassis equipment	Depends on configuration	Published M40i equipment includes adaptive M suspension, M Sport brakes and M Sport differential
Likely running-cost profile	Generally the less performance-intensive configuration	Potentially higher fuel, tyre, brake and insurance costs
Best suited to	Drivers who want the roadster experience without prioritising maximum power	Drivers who want the stronger engine and more performance-focused setup

Which should you choose?

Choose the sDrive20i if your priority is the Z4's styling, two-seat roadster layout and open-air experience, and you do not need the strongest acceleration. Choose the M40i if you specifically value the six-cylinder engine, higher output and more performance-oriented hardware, and are comfortable with potentially higher ownership costs.

Pricing

No single price is stated in this guide because ex-showroom prices, on-road prices, taxes, insurance, dealer offers, model availability and registration costs can change. For a valid comparison, request a dated written quotation showing ex-showroom price, road tax, registration, insurance, accessories, service package, extended warranty and any discount separately.

11. Advantages and disadvantages

Advantages	Disadvantages
Distinctive roadster styling and open-top driving	Only two seats
Strong turbocharged engine options	Limited luggage space
Rear-wheel-drive handling character	Low stance can be inconvenient on rough roads and speed breakers
Premium cabin and modern infotainment on equipped models	Premium tyres, brakes, insurance and repairs can be expensive
M40i offers particularly strong acceleration	Soft top requires condition checks and proper care
A more special experience than an ordinary daily sedan	Not the best choice for maximum practicality or low-cost ownership

Who is the BMW Z4 for?

It suits someone who wants a personal sports car, values driving enjoyment and styling, and can accept the compromises of a two-seat convertible. It is less suitable as the only vehicle for a household that needs rear seats, generous boot space or economical daily commuting.

12. Used-car inspection and purchase checklist

Use this checklist when inspecting a new or used BMW Z4. For a used car, an independent pre-purchase inspection by a BMW-specialist workshop is strongly recommended.

Documents and identity

- Verify VIN/chassis number, registration certificate, model year, variant and ownership history.
- Match the engine/variant and installed equipment to the vehicle's build sheet.
- Review service invoices, maintenance records, recall or campaign completion and warranty documents.
- Check loan hypothecation, insurance history and any available accident or claim records.

Mechanical and electronic checks

- Start the engine from cold where possible; note warning lights, unusual noises, smoke or rough running.
- Scan control modules for diagnostic trouble codes and check that warning lights operate correctly.
- Inspect engine bay and underbody for leaks, corrosion, impact damage and non-factory repairs.
- Check transmission operation at low speed and during acceleration; test all driving modes.
- Inspect brake discs and pads, tyre age and tread, wheel damage, alignment and suspension noises.
- Test air conditioning, heating, infotainment, Bluetooth, cameras, parking sensors, windows, locks and seat adjustments.

Convertible-specific checks

- Operate the roof fully according to the manual and check for hesitation, warning messages or uneven movement.
- Inspect roof fabric, rear window if applicable, seals and the surrounding trim.
- Check carpets, boot and cabin for dampness, water stains, mould or unusual odours.
- Inspect roof drainage areas and ask whether any roof or water-ingress repairs have been done.
- Drive with the roof raised and lowered, where safe, to listen for abnormal wind noise or rattles.

Road test

- Test on both smooth and typical local roads, watching for scraping and excessive impact harshness.
- Check steering tracking, braking stability, acceleration, gear changes and suspension noises.
- Confirm visibility and comfort in the driving position, and practise parking in a realistic space.
- Do not test maximum speed or aggressive driving on public roads.

Before paying

- Get a written, itemised price and the full list of included and optional equipment.
- Confirm warranty, service-package coverage and exclusions in writing.
- Obtain insurance quotes and ask for realistic tyre, brake and scheduled-service costs.
- For a used vehicle, negotiate based on documented repairs and inspection findings—not only the odometer.

13. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Roadster	A sporty open-top car, traditionally with two seats.
Turbocharger	A device that uses exhaust energy to compress intake air, helping an engine produce more power.
Inline-four / inline-six	Four or six cylinders arranged in a single row.
Torque	A measure of rotational force, expressed here in newton-metres (Nm).
Rear-wheel drive (RWD)	The engine's drive torque is delivered to the rear wheels.
Steptronic Sport	BMW's automatic transmission branding; the exact transmission calibration depends on model.
Adaptive suspension	Suspension that can adjust its damping behaviour according to conditions or selected modes.
Differential	A drivetrain component that allows driven wheels to rotate at different speeds; an M Sport differential can improve traction and cornering behaviour.
Ex-showroom price	Vehicle price before many on-road costs such as registration, road tax and insurance.
On-road price	The total price to register and use the vehicle, including applicable charges and selected extras.

Official references and further reading

The following BMW sources were used for core specifications, feature descriptions and warranty context. The documents are older model-year releases, so consult BMW India for the latest specification and availability.

BMW Group India — The all-new BMW Z4 Roadster launched in India

BMW Group India — BMW Z4 M40i specification and feature overview

BMW India — Z4 sDrive20i specification sheet

BMW India — Z4 M40i specification sheet (November 2023)

BMW India — Warranty policy

Final note

Specifications, equipment, prices, fuel economy, warranty coverage and availability may change by model year and market. This guide is for general information and comparison; always verify the exact vehicle with official documentation before making a purchase.